

JAMES HOUSTON

IT PROFESSIONAL • IT SUPPORT • SECURITY ANALYST

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CompTIA Security+ certified cybersecurity student pursuing a B.S. in Information & Cybersecurity Operations with a 4.0 GPA. Hands-on technical training across security operations, enterprise networking, Cisco routing/switching and ASA firewalls, Microsoft identity, Windows/Linux administration, cloud infrastructure, automation, and security analytics. Building an enterprise-style security lab focused on SIEM monitoring, endpoint telemetry, detection engineering, incident investigation, adversary simulation, and AI-assisted security operations.

CERTIFICATION

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations: SIEM, Wazuh, Microsoft Sentinel, SOAR, Microsoft Defender, Defender XDR, EDR/XDR, incident response, log analysis, threat hunting, phishing analysis, DLP, vulnerability assessment, digital forensics, malware analysis

Offensive / Defensive Security: Kali Linux, Metasploit, Nmap, reconnaissance, enumeration, attack simulation, adversary emulation, detection engineering, security monitoring, Windows telemetry, Sysmon

Identity & Microsoft: Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft 365, Active Directory, Entra Connect, Pass-Through Authentication, IdFix, PIM, MFA, Conditional Access, Group Policy, LDAP, RADIUS, DNS, DHCP, Windows Server

Networking & Network Security: Cisco IOS CLI, switching, VLANs, trunking, routing, OSPF, ACLs, Cisco ASA, NAT/PAT, IPv4/IPv6, subnetting, TCP/IP, OSI, VPN/IPsec, TLS, network troubleshooting, SDN, SD-WAN, SASE

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud Platform, S3, EC2, AWS IAM, CloudFormation, Azure ARM, Azure Policy, Azure Automation, cloud networking, Infrastructure as Code

Systems, Virtualization & Automation: Windows 10/11, Windows Server, Ubuntu, AlmaLinux, Kali Linux, Linux administration, Proxmox, Hyper-V, VMware, VirtualBox, PowerShell, Python, Bash, Ansible, Git/GitHub

AI-Assisted Security: Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, tool-enabled workflows, AI-assisted investigation, security automation, K-Means, DBSCAN, PCA, Isolation Forest, anomaly detection

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

Library IT Assistant (Federal Work Study) – ECPI University

Richmond, VA | 2024–Present

- Provide front-line technical assistance to students and faculty with Windows workstations, login, connectivity, printing, and general technology issues.
- Reimage Windows computers and prepare workstations for student and classroom use.
- Configure and connect workstations, monitors, peripherals, and cabling while maintaining an organized computer lab environment.
- Troubleshoot common hardware and connectivity problems, communicate issues to technical and non-technical users, and escalate advanced problems when appropriate.

PERSONAL CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

Personal Enterprise Security Lab | Proxmox • Active Directory • Windows • Wazuh • Sysmon • Kali • Metasploit • MCP

- Designing and operating a virtualized enterprise-style environment on Proxmox with a Windows Server domain controller, domain-joined Windows 11 endpoint, Linux systems, and dedicated offensive-security infrastructure.
- Building a controlled attack-and-defense workflow using Kali Linux, Nmap, and Metasploit for reconnaissance, enumeration, adversary simulation, and validation of defensive controls.
- Deploying Wazuh agents and Sysmon telemetry to centralize endpoint visibility and support security monitoring, detection engineering, alert triage, log analysis, and incident-response workflows.
- Developing detections by generating controlled malicious or suspicious activity, examining Windows and endpoint telemetry, investigating alerts, and iterating on detection logic.
- Experimenting with Model Context Protocol (MCP) and AI agents to connect AI-assisted workflows with lab tools and infrastructure for investigation, analysis, automation, and security operations use cases.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS & LABS

Enterprise Identity & Microsoft 365 Administration

- Configured Microsoft Entra ID and Microsoft 365 identities, users, groups, authentication settings, administrative roles, MFA, Conditional Access, and privileged access concepts.
- Built and validated hybrid identity workflows by preparing on-premises Active Directory, correcting directory attributes with IdFix, deploying Entra Connect, and configuring Pass-Through Authentication.

Cisco Routing, Switching & Network Security

- Configured Cisco IOS environments through Routing & Switching I and II, including VLANs, trunking, routing, OSPF, ACLs, IPv4/IPv6 addressing, subnetting, and network troubleshooting.
- Configured Cisco ASA firewall environments and applied NAT/PAT, access control, routing, and network security concepts across routed and switched topologies.

Cloud Infrastructure & Automation

- Worked across AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud Platform with compute, storage, identity, access control, networking, and cloud security concepts.
- Created and validated AWS CloudFormation and Azure ARM Infrastructure as Code templates and applied configuration automation concepts using Ansible.

Windows, Linux & Security Analytics Labs

- Configured Windows Server services including Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and Group Policy; managed users, groups, permissions, and system services.
- Administered Linux systems from the command line and used Kali Linux and Nmap for network discovery, host identification, open-port analysis, and security testing.
- Applied K-Means, DBSCAN, PCA, and Isolation Forest to security-oriented datasets for clustering, dimensionality reduction, and anomaly detection.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Warehouse Associate – Amazon Fulfillment Center

2018–Present

- Work in a high-volume, technology-driven fulfillment environment while following established safety, security, and operational procedures.
- Consistently manage productivity and accuracy expectations while adapting to changing workloads and operational priorities.
- Maintain employment while attending school full-time and concurrently working an ECPI library work-study position, demonstrating sustained time management, reliability, and ability to balance competing responsibilities.

Mail Carrier – United States Postal Service

2021–2023

- Provided customer-facing service while handling sensitive mail and information with accuracy, professionalism, and discretion.
- Worked independently, managed daily priorities, and resolved customer and delivery issues in a time-sensitive environment.

Professional Highlights

- Led front-facing teams, trained coworkers, resolved customer concerns, and worked toward daily service and performance goals.
- Developed strong communication, conflict-resolution, prioritization, teamwork, and problem-solving skills in fast-paced retail and food-service environments.

EDUCATION

B.S., Information & Cybersecurity Operations

ECPI University | GPA: 4.00

Expected April 2027